

YOUR WEEKLY MICROSOFT SENTINEL BRIEFING

Sentinel Weekly

NO. 1 • JULY 24 - 30, 2026

Detections become code in Repositories, an AI agent takes over ASIM parsers, and the Azure portal clock now runs to March 2027.

NEW EVERY THURSDAY • CURATED BY PHILLIPE CHAVES DE LIMA

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Welcome to Edition 1. The format is simple: one 5 minute read every Thursday with what shipped in and around Microsoft Sentinel, what it means in a real SOC, and what to check in your workspace before Friday. Edition 1 casts a slightly wider net across late July while we get rolling. From Edition 2 on, it is a clean week.

On the radar this week

- **Custom detection rules land in Sentinel Repositories** (*Microsoft Learn, Preview*): Manage custom detection rules as code in GitHub or Azure DevOps, sync them into Sentinel through Repositories, or deploy them straight from BICEP CLI. Detection as code finally covers the Defender portal's native rule type, not just classic analytics rules.
- **An AI agent now drafts ASIM parsers** (*Sentinel Blog*): Microsoft announced the ASIM Parser Creation agentic experience, which takes over the schema mapping and KQL validation grind of parser development.
- **Security for Microsoft Agent 365 with Defender is GA** (*Microsoft Learn*): Discovery, security posture, threat detection, and real-time protection for the AI agents living in your tenant, with an Agent 365 license as the entry ticket.
- **March 31, 2027 is the date that matters** (*Sentinel Blog*): The old "Sentinel leaves the Azure portal by July 1, 2026" deadline did not happen. Support runs through March 31, 2027. The move to the Defender portal still needs a plan, just not a panic.

In this edition

Shipped and live now

[Custom detection rules as code in Repositories \(Preview\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

This is the one I would read first. Custom detection rules are the Defender portal's native detection type, and until now they lived outside every serious detection as code setup: no version control, no pull request review, no environment promotion. Analytics rules had Repositories. Custom detections had the UI.

That gap just closed. With the Microsoft Security BICEP extension you keep [custom detection rules](#) in your GitHub or Azure DevOps repository, sync them into Microsoft Sentinel through the Repositories feature, or deploy them directly using BICEP CLI.

On Monday morning in a real SOC this means one pipeline for both rule types: review detection changes like code changes, roll back a bad rule in minutes, promote from dev to prod without click-ops. If you run more than a handful of custom detections, put this preview in your lab this week.

[ASIM parser creation goes agentic](#) *(Sentinel Blog, July 15)*

Anyone who has normalized a custom source into ASIM knows the grind: read the schema, map the fields, fight the KQL, run the validations, repeat. Microsoft now ships an agentic experience that drafts ASIM parsers for you, with schema design and KQL validation built into the flow. The how-to lives here: [Create ASIM parsers using an AI agent](#).

Two honest caveats. It is still your name on the parser, so validate the output against real data before it ships. And agent-written parsers make custom source onboarding faster, which means more sources and more ingestion. Your cost management does not get a holiday.

Agentic SOC watch

[A portable, autonomous malware investigation agent](#) *(Sentinel Blog, July 13)*

A look at an agent that runs a malware investigation across multiple analytical stages instead of leaving the analyst to stitch 5 tools together. Interesting less for this specific agent and more for the direction: portable, autonomous agents as SOC building blocks.

[Graph tools in the Sentinel MCP server \(Preview\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

The MCP server's graph tool collection lets you, or your agent, reason over relationships across identities, devices, and threats to spot coverage gaps and dependencies. Shipped in June and easy to have missed. If you are experimenting with MCP against your workspace, this is the collection to try first.

Next door: Defender XDR and Entra

[Security for Microsoft Agent 365 with Defender \(GA\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

With an Agent 365 license, Defender now covers the AI agents in your tenant: discovery, posture, threat detection and investigation, and real-time protection. Onboarding means enabling data collection, connecting the Microsoft 365 app connector, and connecting Copilot Studio. Pair it with the [AgentsInfo table \(Preview\)](#) in advanced hunting to see which agents actually live in your tenant. The agent sprawl conversation is coming to your org either way. Better to walk in with an inventory.

[Link UEBA behavior results to incidents \(Preview\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

Behavior records from the BehaviorInfo table can now be linked to new or existing incidents in advanced hunting, with alert metadata and entities populated for you. Small feature, real triage minutes saved.

[SOC Identity Responder role \(Public Preview\)](#) *(Microsoft Learn)*

A built-in Entra role that lets the SOC run identity containment actions without holding broad admin rights. If your incident response still borrows a Global Admin for containment, this is your least privilege exit.

The clock to watch

March 31, 2027. The original plan retired Sentinel in the Azure portal by July 1, 2026. Microsoft moved that date in January: the Azure portal experience is supported through March 31, 2027, and all investment goes into the Defender portal. Eight months sounds comfortable. It is one budget cycle, one RBAC redesign, and one automation review. If your migration plan is still a bookmark, start with Microsoft's [transition guidance](#).

One query to steal

While your detections move into git, keep an eye on who is still editing rules by hand. This surfaces analytics rule writes from the last 7 days:

```
AzureActivity
| where TimeGenerated > ago(7d)
| where OperationNameValue contains "securityinsights/alertrules/write"
| project TimeGenerated, Caller, ResourceGroup, ActivityStatusValue
| sort by TimeGenerated desc
// illustrative, validate in your workspace first
```

If a name shows up that is not your pipeline's service principal, that is a conversation worth having today.

That's Edition 1

If this saved you a browser tab or 12, subscribe and the next one lands every Thursday. Tell me in the comments what Edition 2 should dig into, and send me the stories I missed.

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Curated by Phillipe Chaves de Lima. New every Thursday.